

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

CHAPTER 8: HOW FREE IS THE PRESS (BY DOROTHY L. SAYERS)

CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"How Free is the Press" is an analytical essay by Dorothy L. Sayers. She argues that while the press is legally free from government censorship during peacetime, it is heavily restricted by two unofficial factors: advertiser revenue and the personal or political biases of wealthy newspaper owners.

15 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. What does the freedom of the press mean in a technical and legal sense?

Ans: In a technical and legal sense, freedom of the press means that there is no government censorship or control over what newspapers can print during peacetime.

Q2. What are the two chief sources of revenue for a newspaper?

Ans: The two chief sources of revenue are: (a) Advertisements from big corporate businesses, and (b) The personal wealth of the newspaper's owner.

Q3. Why can a newspaper not afford to publish articles against its advertisers?

Ans: A newspaper cannot afford to do so because it depends heavily on advertiser money to survive. Going against them would mean losing financial support.

Q4. How does the personal bias of a newspaper owner affect public news?

Ans: The owner can use their power to suppress certain truths and print biased stories to promote their own political ambitions or personal interests.

Q5. What are the various ways newspapers misrepresent facts according to Sayers?

Ans: Newspapers misrepresent facts through sensationalism, selective elicitation, deliberate suppression of context, and flat exaggeration of stories.

Q6. What does the phrase "Sensationalism" mean in modern journalism?

Ans: Sensationalism means over-dramatizing ordinary news with shocking headlines or exaggerated language to attract more readers and increase sales.

Q7. How do newspapers manipulate interviews?



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Ans: They often misquote the speaker, change the tone of the conversation, or pick a few sentences out of context to make the story look controversial.

Q8. What is the role of the public in keeping the press honest?

Ans: The public must be critical and alert. If readers refuse to buy newspapers that spread lies or gossip, the press will be forced to be accurate.

Q9. Why is the press restricted or censored during times of war?

Ans: During wartime, the press is censored by the government to protect national security, keep military secrets safe, and maintain public unity.

Q10. What does the author mean by "miracle mongering"?

Ans: It means creating fake or highly exaggerated stories about scientific inventions or events to make them look like supernatural miracles.

Q11. Why does Dorothy L. Sayers call the press an "un-elected judiciary"?

Ans: She calls it that because the press often holds its own public trials, pronouncing people guilty or innocent before a real court of law can decide.

Q12. How does the press handle the personal lives of famous individuals?

Ans: The press often invades their privacy, invents false rumors, and twists their statements just to create juicy gossip for public consumption.

Q13. What is the danger of a controlled or biased press in a democracy?

Ans: A biased press misleads citizens with false information, making it impossible for people to vote wisely or form correct political opinions.

Q14. How can a newspaper destroy a person's reputation?

Ans: A newspaper can destroy a reputation by printing a prominent false accusation on the front page and hiding the apology or correction in a tiny corner later.

Q15. What is the central message of Dorothy L. Sayers in this essay?

Ans: Her central message is that true democracy requires a press that is free not just from government control, but also from commercial greed and dishonesty.

 50 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'How Free is the Press' is an insightful essay written by: (A) H.E. Bates (B) Dorothy L. Sayers (C) Pearl S. Buck (D) Anton Chekhov

2. Dorothy L. Sayers was an English essayist, poet, and celebrated writer of: (A) sci-fi (B) detective fiction (C) historical drama (D) children's comics

3. Dorothy L. Sayers was born in 1893 and passed away in the year: (A) 1948 (B) 1957 (C) 1969 (D)



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1975

4. Dorothy L. Sayers was one of the first women to graduate from: (A) Cambridge (B) Oxford University (C) Harvard (D) Delhi University
5. The freedom of the press is considered an essential pillar of a true: (A) monarchy (B) democracy (C) dictatorship (D) anarchy
6. Under normal peacetime conditions, the British press is legally: (A) banned (B) free from government censorship (C) controlled by the army (D) tax-free
7. Restrictions or official censorship are heavily imposed on the press during: (A) festivals (B) general elections (C) wartime / national emergency (D) monsoons
8. The first unofficial restriction on freedom of the press comes from the: (A) judiciary (B) advertisers / finance (C) police (D) teachers
9. The second unofficial source of restriction on the press is the: (A) reader (B) wealth and bias of the owner (C) printer (D) postman
10. A newspaper cannot dare to go against the commercial interests of its major: (A) critics (B) advertisers (C) delivery boys (D) printers
11. The revenue generated from selling the newspaper copies covers only a _____ fraction of its costs.: (A) large (B) small (C) full (D) zero
12. The public is often misled because newspapers substitute gossip for genuine: (A) fiction (B) accurate news (C) games (D) poems
13. Making regular stories look highly shocking and dramatic is called: (A) accuracy (B) sensationalism (C) education (D) philosophy
14. When a newspaper picks only convenient parts of an interview, it is guilty of selective: (A) elicitation / reporting (B) praising (C) rewarding (D) testing
15. If a journalist invents details that never happened, it is called flat: (A) correction (B) invention / fabrication (C) support (D) truth
16. "Miracle mongering" by the press is related to the exaggeration of: (A) sports scores (B) scientific or general facts (C) political speeches (D) movie reviews
17. The author points out that an ordinary reader rarely tries to verify the _____ of news.: (A) price (B) print quality (C) absolute truth / accuracy (D) length
18. A newspaper owner often has personal or hidden political: (A) books (B) ambitions / biases (C) relative (D) factories
19. A controlled press can make the public think whatever the _____ wants them to think.: (A) school (B) newspaper management/owner (C) court (D) poor man
20. Dorothy L. Sayers highlights that journalists often change the _____ of a speech.: (A) language only (B) entire context and meaning (C) price (D) title
21. If a person tries to correct a false report, the newspaper prints the correction in a: (A) massive front headline (B) tiny obscure corner (C) special book (D) separate magazine



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22. The press can easily make a hero look like a villain through targeted: (A) propaganda (B) advertisements (C) poems (D) logic
23. The text describes the press as an un-elected body that exercises immense: (A) physical labor (B) social and political power (C) military force (D) religious duty
24. A healthy democracy cannot function without an honest and _____ citizenry.: (A) critical / alert (B) sleeping (C) uneducated (D) violent
25. The author gives several examples of news stories where her own statements were completely: (A) praised (B) twisted and misreported (C) ignored (D) rewarded
26. When a paper combines two unrelated events to create a scandal, it is a breach of: (A) law (B) journalistic ethics / truth (C) trade (D) grammar
27. The editorial policy of a popular daily newspaper is controlled by chief: (A) students (B) vested interests/proprietors (C) readers (D) postmen
28. Big corporate houses use their financial power to buy space for: (A) charity (B) advertisements (C) poems (D) novels
29. A newspaper that loses its advertisers will quickly face financial: (A) success (B) ruin / bankruptcy (C) growth (D) award
30. The word 'Censorship' means official examination and _____ of information.: (A) distribution (B) suppression / restriction (C) printing (D) writing
31. The author urges readers not to accept newspaper stories with blind: (A) anger (B) faith / belief (C) hatred (D) fear
32. The tone of Dorothy L. Sayers in this lesson is highly: (A) romantic (B) critical and analytical (C) superstitious (D) comedic
33. News channels and papers often prioritize speed over absolute: (A) color (B) factual accuracy (C) font size (D) weight
34. The press often acts as a judge and jury, which hampers a fair legal: (A) election (B) trial in court (C) trade (D) education
35. The press can easily manipulate the emotions of the mass public during an: (A) examination (B) election / crisis (C) vacation (D) auction
36. "How Free is the Press" is categorized structurally as a/an: (A) short story (B) analytical essay (C) descriptive poem (D) diary entry
37. The author claims that the press enjoys power without any real: (A) money (B) accountability / responsibility (C) office (D) printing press
38. Misreporting can cause massive damage to a person's public: (A) wealth (B) reputation and dignity (C) health (D) clothes
39. The press creates a false sense of public opinion by publishing biased: (A) dictionaries (B) surveys and polls (C) mathematical tables (D) maps
40. The press is legally free, but practically it is a slave to finance and: (A) nature (B) propaganda /



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owners (C) weather (D) children

41. Yellow journalism is another name for sensational and biased: (A) farming (B) reporting / press (C) drawing (D) cooking

42. The main target of the author's criticism is the modern commercialized: (A) educational system (B) press / newspaper industry (C) healthcare system (D) sports body

43. Readers should look for multiple sources to avoid being victims of one-sided: (A) education (B) news propaganda (C) music (D) sports

44. Deliberate suppression of the context of a quote makes it completely: (A) accurate (B) misleading (C) educational (D) joyful

45. In times of peace, a democratic government should theoretically avoid press: (A) taxation (B) censorship (C) reading (D) awards

46. The press can create massive public panic by printing unverified: (A) textbooks (B) rumors and scares (C) poetry (D) laws

47. Advertisers pay large sums because newspapers have massive public: (A) weight (B) circulation / readership (C) offices (D) vehicle

48. The chapter teaches us the importance of media literacy and independent: (A) sleeping (B) critical thinking (C) spending (D) fighting

49. A newspaper owner can dictate what opinions should be highlighted on the: (A) sports page only (B) editorial page / front page (C) back cover (D) envelope

50. Dorothy L. Sayers' views are highly relevant to today's world of social media and fake: (A) accounts (B) news / information (C) currencies (D) products

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